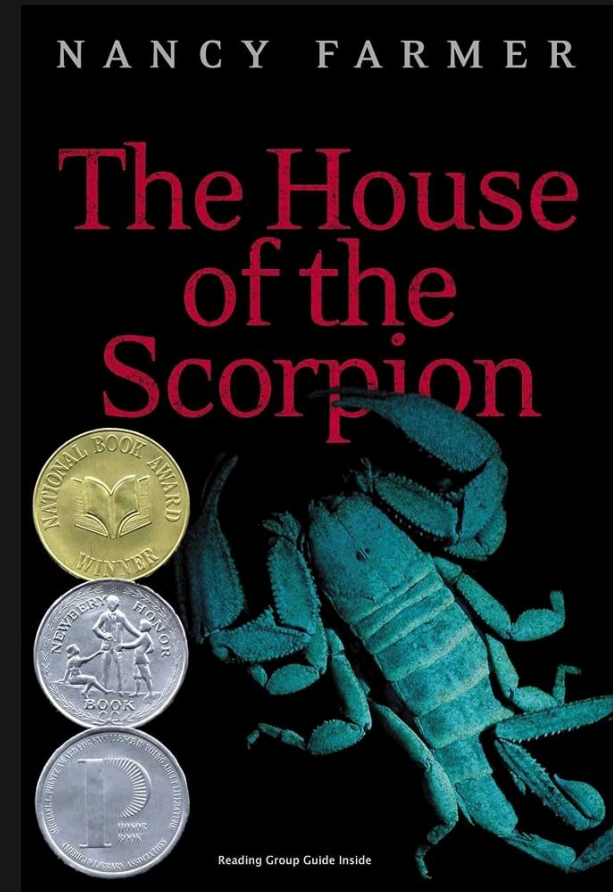


BOOK INTRODUCTION

The House of the Scorpion

By Nancy Farmer

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Software engineering





PERSONAL MOTIVATION

Why This Book?



The Intriguing Title

Instantly drawn by the word "Scorpion."



The Immediate Hook

Throws right into the creation of a human clone



The Deep Question

What if human cloning actually becomes a reality in our lifetime?

THE SETTING

Welcome to Opium

The Border Nation

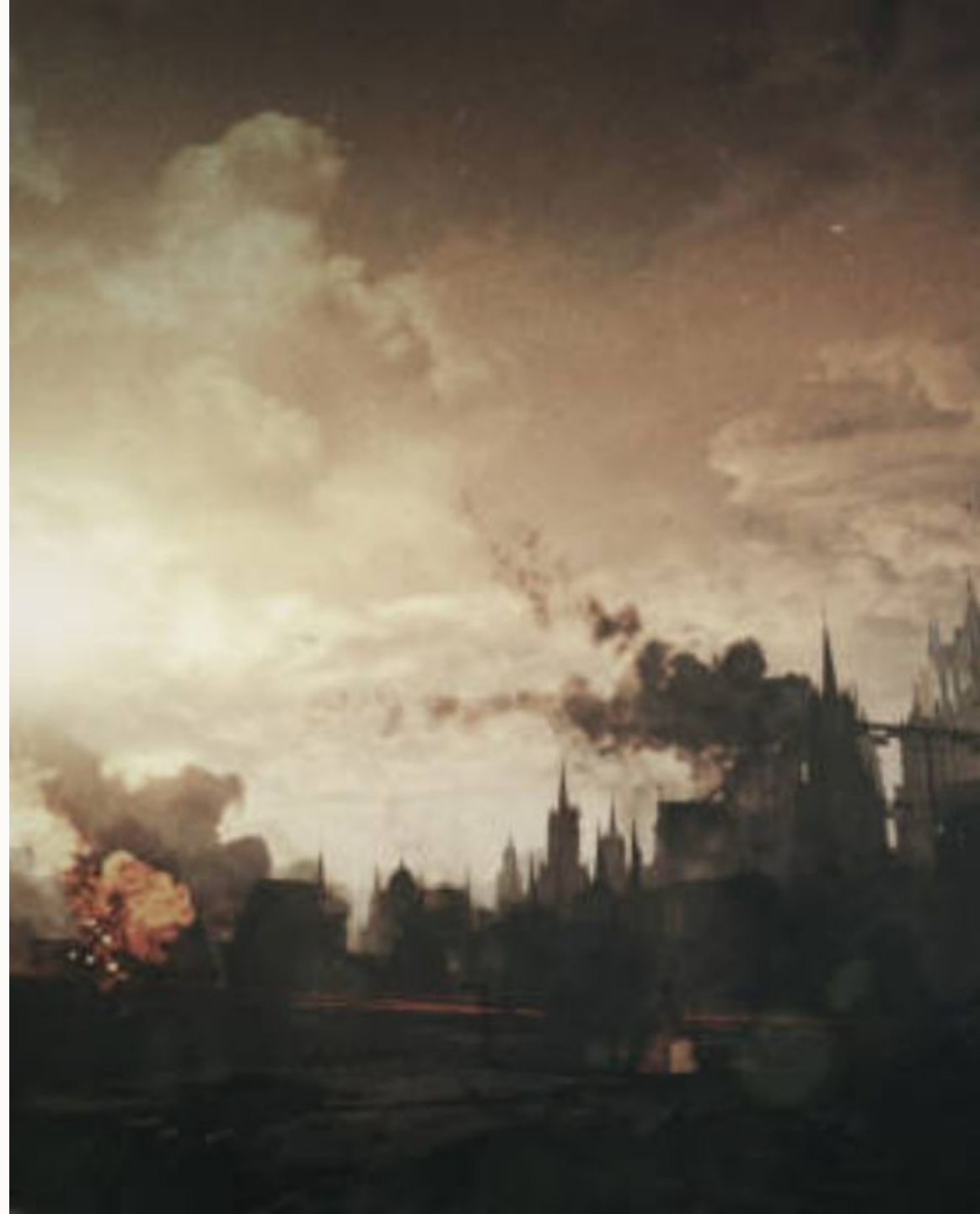
Nestled between the US and Mexico.

El Patrón

Ruled by a powerful, ruthless drug lord.

A Dark Economy

Built on poppy fields and forced labor.



THE STORY OF MATTEO ALACRÁN

The Plot Overview



The Creation

Matt is the exact genetic clone of the lord El Patron.

Matt is treated differently.
He is educated and given a life of luxury.



The Realization

As Matt grows older, he discovers the truth about his existence.

He was created solely for spare body parts to keep the dictator alive.



The Escape

Matt desperates to escape from Opium, and starts his journey to claim his own humanity.



Core Discussion Themes

1

Cloning Ethics

If we create a perfect human copy, is it moral to harvest them?

2

Nature vs. Nurture

Matt has the exact DNA of a cruel dictator, but does that mean he is destined to be evil too?

3

The Human Soul

What actually separates a 'copy' from a 'real' human being?

Questions & Discussion

"A provocative look at the ethical boundaries of our technological future."



Image Sources



<https://backiee.com/static/wallpapers/1000x563/446878.jpg>

Source: backiee.com



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